

AFGHANISTAN

Afghanistan MUN Research Dossier

1. Key Country Details Table

Detail	Information
Full Name	Islamic Emirate of Afghanistan (<i>de facto</i>) / Islamic Republic of Afghanistan (<i>previous</i>)
Short Form	Afghanistan
Capital	Kabul
Region (UN)	Asia-Pacific
Government Type	De facto Taliban regime (since 2021); unrecognized by the UN
Head of State	Hibatullah Akhundzada (Supreme Leader, Taliban)
Head of Government	Hasan Akhund (Acting Prime Minister, Taliban)
Currency	Afghan Afghani (AFN)
UN Member Since	1946
MUN Standing	Typically represented by pre-2021 republic at UN; issues of legitimacy and humanitarian crisis dominate representation.

Recommended Books on Afghanistan's Foreign Policy and UN Role

1. **"No Good Men Among the Living: America, the Taliban, and the War Through Afghan Eyes"** – Anand Gopal
2. **"Ghost Wars"** – Steve Coll
3. **"Afghanistan: A Cultural and Political History"** – Thomas Barfield
4. **"The Great Gamble: The Soviet War in Afghanistan"** – Gregory Feifer
5. **"Taliban: Militant Islam, Oil and Fundamentalism in Central Asia"** – Ahmed Rashid

Afghanistan – UNCSW Engagement

Afghanistan's engagement with the UNCSW has been marked by significant challenges, especially following the Taliban's return to power in 2021. The situation of women and girls in Afghanistan has deteriorated, with numerous restrictions imposed on their rights and freedoms. The UNCSW and other international bodies have been actively monitoring and addressing these issues through reports, resolutions, and advocacy.

TTable: Afghanistan – UNCSW Engagement

Title	Link	Relevance to UNCSW Agendas
Security Council Emphasizes That Punitive Restrictions on Women's Rights, Escalating Hunger, Insecurity Taking Devastating Toll in Afghanistan	Link	Highlights the UN Security Council's concerns about the deteriorating situation for women in Afghanistan, aligning with UNCSW's focus on women's rights.
Afghanistan Gender Country Profile 2024	Link	Provides a detailed analysis of gender equality in Afghanistan, informing UNCSW's policy recommendations.
Situation of Women and Girls in Afghanistan	Link	Outlines the challenges faced by Afghan women and girls, serving as a basis for UNCSW's advocacy efforts.
Draft Resolution II: Situation of Women and Girls in Afghanistan	Link	A draft resolution addressing the plight of Afghan women, reflecting UNCSW's commitment to their rights.
UN / Afghanistan Women – UN Audiovisual Library	Link	A video resource highlighting the situation of women in Afghanistan, useful for UNCSW's awareness campaigns.
Discrimination Against Women and Girls in Afghanistan: Report of the Secretary-General	Link	A comprehensive report detailing discrimination, aiding UNCSW's policy formulation.
UN / Afghan Women – UN Audiovisual Library	Link	Features discussions on Afghan women's issues, supporting UNCSW's information dissemination.

From Afghanistan to New York: Afghan Women Calling – UN Web TV	Link	Showcases Afghan women's voices at the UN, aligning with UNCSW's empowerment goals.
Press Briefing: The Situation of Women and Girls in Afghanistan	Link	Provides insights into the challenges faced by Afghan women, informing UNCSW's strategies.
Afghan Women Want the CSW to Help Them Fight for Equality	Link	Highlights Afghan women's appeals to the UNCSW, emphasizing the need for support.
UN / Women in Afghanistan – UNifeed	Link	Offers visual documentation of women's conditions, aiding UNCSW's advocacy.
The Power of Inclusion: Afghan Women and Regional Prosperity	Link	Discusses the importance of including Afghan women in regional development, aligning with UNCSW's objectives.
OHCHR / Afghanistan Women – UNifeed	Link	Reports on human rights concerns, supporting UNCSW's monitoring efforts.
Afghanistan Secures a Coveted Seat at the UN Women's Commission	Link	Details Afghanistan's membership in the UNCSW, highlighting its role in gender equality discussions.
UN Women Afghanistan Country Office	Link	Provides information on UN Women's initiatives in Afghanistan, complementing UNCSW's work.
Summary Report of Country-Wide Women's Consultations	Link	Presents Afghan women's perspectives, informing UNCSW's policy decisions.
Updated Concept Note – CSW Official Side Event	Link	Details discussions on Afghan women's issues, supporting UNCSW's event planning.
Background Guide UNCSW – BITSUMUN Pilani 2025	Link	Offers educational material on UNCSW's role, including Afghanistan's context.
UN / Afghanistan Women – UNifeed	Link	Visual content highlighting women's issues, aiding UNCSW's outreach.

UN Women Afghanistan Country Office	Link	Details ongoing programs and initiatives, complementing UNCSW's efforts.
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Unique Aspects of Afghanistan's Engagement with UNCSW:

- **Historic Membership:** Afghanistan made a notable stride towards gender equality by securing a seat on the UNCSW in 2020. This achievement highlights the country's dedication to advancing women's rights and representation on a global stage.
- **Post-2021 Challenges:** Since the Taliban took control again, Afghanistan's involvement with the UN Commission on the Status of Women (UNCSW) has been marked by various reports and resolutions that highlight the harsh restrictions placed on women's rights.
- **International Advocacy:** Afghan women are finding their voices through the UNCSW platforms, shining a spotlight on their struggles and championing their rights.
- **Human Rights Focus:** The UNCSW has been crucial in highlighting and tackling human rights abuses faced by women in Afghanistan, demonstrating its strong dedication to gender equality.